

# ITC: Navigating A TURN To Reimagine The Future

Excerpts from the Address by

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Enduring Value

A few months ago, India demonstrated to the world its firm resolve to counter terrorism with zero tolerance. The swift and decisive action, led commendably by the Hon'ble Prime Minister, and the indomitable courage demonstrated by our Armed Forces have earned universal respect and admiration.

Operation Sindoor also unveiled India's transformation into a global player of significance in manufacturing indigenous, hi-tech defence systems. This remarkable progress is indeed a testament to the Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision to 'Make in India' and build an Atmanirbhar Bharat – a dream that is today becoming a reality with India emerging as an economic, strategic and technological powerhouse.

> **Your Company has always lived by its credo of Nation First: Sab Saath Badhein, that has inspired a commitment to subserve larger national priorities that puts the Country before the Corporation and the Institution ahead of the Individual.**

ITC's world-class Indian brands create, capture and retain larger value in India and generate large-scale livelihoods. Across your Company's businesses, over **90% of value-addition** takes place in the country, enlarging ITC's contribution to the economy. Committed to the 'Make in India' vision, ITC has built **40 state-of-the-art manufacturing assets,** which enrich your Company's robust **ecosystem of 250 dedicated factories and 7,500 MSMEs,** fostering local entrepreneurship. Your Company's deep engagement in agriculture has empowered millions of farmers, aiding a virtuous cycle of rising incomes, consumption, investment and livelihoods. ITC's Life Sciences & Technology Centre (LSTC) is an epicentre of agile science-based innovation that powers the development of your Company's differentiated products. Your Company's impactful social investment initiatives have expanded to over 300 districts across 24 States, helping transform lives and landscapes. ITC's inclusive businesses and value chains today **support nearly 9 million livelihoods,** serving national imperatives.

We live in an era of unprecedented change. Geo-political conflicts, geo-economic fragmentation, elevated uncertainty in trade policies, the accelerated climate crisis, rapidly changing consumer preferences and regulations as well as the societal impact of dynamically evolving areas such as Artificial Intelligence are today raising significant concerns.

> **We are indeed navigating a critical TURN, a pivotal inflection point shaped by Turbulence, Uncertainty and Rapid change that calls for Novel strategies, innovation and solutions to reimagine the future. This underscores the imperative to redefine growth and competitiveness, build resilience and adopt a new paradigm of compassionate capitalism.**

## India's Ascent in a Turbulent World

This is truly India's moment, and one that ushers in unparalleled opportunities emerging from visionary policies of the Government, as well as the country's young demography, increasing disposable incomes, rapid urbanisation, accelerated digital adoption and entrepreneurial spirit.

The year gone by has witnessed challenges from a weak external sector, dumping of cheap imports and inflationary pressures leading to softening of demand. However, the future outlook remains promising, on the back of the continued thrust on reforms, strong domestic drivers and macro-economic stability.

As India ascends on the global stage, the opportunities are both vast and transformative. With this promise also comes responsibility. At ITC, we believe that enterprises have a vital role to play — not only by partnering India's growth story, but also by creating larger societal value for stakeholders. It is this north-star that inspires us to build an institution that is resilient and competitive, a force for good and a source of enduring pride for India.

### *ITC: Key Highlights 2024-25*

A significant milestone was achieved with the demerger of the Hotels Business into ITC Hotels Limited. In the 9 months ended 31st December, 2024, the Hotels Business posted its highest ever